

AXIOM AI TECHNOLOGIES

Business Continuity & Disaster Recovery Strategy

Business Continuity & Disaster Recovery

Document Control

Field	Value
Document ID	BCP-DR-STR-001
Version	1.0
Status	Portfolio Demonstration
Classification	Internal Use
Owner	Information Security / GRC
Review Frequency	Annual and following material change or significant exercise
Related Artifact	Axiom AI Technologies Business Impact Analysis (BIA)

Portfolio Disclaimer: This is a fictional portfolio artifact designed to demonstrate practical cybersecurity, GRC, business continuity, and disaster recovery capabilities. It does not represent an actual organization's certification, audit opinion, or operational capability.

1. Executive Summary

This Business Continuity & Disaster Recovery (BCP/DR) Strategy establishes the strategic approach Axiom AI Technologies would use to maintain or restore critical business and technology-supported activities following a disruptive event.

The strategy is derived from the accompanying Business Impact Analysis (BIA), which identifies critical processes, dependencies, recovery priorities, Maximum Tolerable Periods of Disruption (MTPD), Recovery Time Objectives (RTO), and Recovery Point Objectives (RPO).

The strategy prioritizes customer-facing services, core SaaS platform operations, security monitoring and incident response, identity and access administration, customer and business communications, and backup/data restoration. Lower-priority governance and supporting activities are restored after critical services are stabilized.

All recovery objectives and operating assumptions in this portfolio artifact are modeled values. In a real organization, they would require validation and approval by business owners, technology owners, executive management, and other relevant stakeholders.

2. Purpose and Objectives

The objectives of this strategy are to:

- Define a consistent, risk-based approach to business continuity and disaster recovery.
- Translate BIA results into practical recovery priorities and strategies.
- Protect the availability, integrity, and recoverability of critical services and information.
- Establish recovery expectations for people, processes, technology, facilities, communications, and suppliers.
- Provide a foundation for detailed Business Continuity Plans, Disaster Recovery Plans, and recovery procedures.
- Define an exercise, testing, maintenance, and continual-improvement approach.

3. Scope

This strategy covers business and technology-supported activities within the modeled Axiom AI Technologies ISMS environment, including:

- Customer operations
- SaaS platform operations
- Identity and access administration
- Security monitoring and incident response
- Software development and release management
- Vulnerability management and security remediation
- Third-party and supplier security management
- ISMS governance and compliance
- Customer and business communications
- Backup, recovery, and data restoration

The strategy addresses:

- People and roles
- Business processes
- Information and technology
- Cloud and supplier dependencies
- Communications
- Recovery priorities
- Testing and exercises
- Plan maintenance and continual improvement

Direct production exploitation, live vulnerability testing, real incident handling, and access to real customer data are outside the scope of this portfolio demonstration.

4. Strategy Principles

4.1 Risk-Based Prioritization

Recovery decisions are based on business impact, service criticality, dependencies, and defined recovery objectives.

4.2 Protect Critical Services First

P1 activities receive priority during major disruptions before lower-priority activities are restored.

4.3 Recover Safely, Not Merely Quickly

Recovery activities must include validation of system integrity, security controls, and service health.

4.4 Dependency-Aware Recovery

Recovery sequences must account for upstream dependencies such as identity, databases, networking, monitoring, communications, and suppliers.

4.5 Resilience Through Alternatives

Where practical, alternate communications, manual procedures, backup services, and secondary processes should reduce dependency on a single capability.

4.6 Documented and Tested Recovery

Plans and procedures should be exercised periodically and updated using lessons learned.

4.7 Continual Improvement

Changes in risk, technology, suppliers, incidents, and business requirements should trigger reassessment of continuity arrangements.

5. Recovery Priorities

Priority	Definition	Recovery Approach
P1 — Critical	Shortest defined recovery objectives; prioritized during major disruption.	Restore core customer, platform, security, access, communications, and recovery capabilities first.
P2 — High	Recover after P1 activities and within the defined business-impact tolerance.	Restore development, vulnerability management, and supplier-security capabilities after critical services stabilize.
P3 — Moderate	Can follow higher-priority activities without unacceptable immediate impact.	Restore governance and compliance activities after operational stability is established.

The P1/P2/P3 classification is a recovery-priority convention used for this portfolio case study. It does not replace organization-specific crisis-management or executive decision-making.

6. BIA-Derived Recovery Requirements

Activity	Criticality	Priority	MTPD	RTO	RPO
Customer Support & Service Operations	High	P1	8h	4h	24h
SaaS Platform Operations	Critical	P1	4h	2h	4h
Identity & Access Administration	High	P1	8h	4h	24h
Security Monitoring & Incident Response	Critical	P1	4h	2h	4h
Software Development & Release Management	High	P2	24h	8h	24h
Vulnerability Management & Security Remediation	High	P2	24h	8h	24h
Third-Party & Supplier Security Management	Medium	P2	72h	24h	48h
ISMS Governance & Compliance	Medium	P3	168h	72h	48h
Customer & Business Communications	High	P1	8h	4h	24h
Backup, Recovery & Data Restoration	Critical	P1	4h	2h	4h

These objectives are modeled assumptions from the BIA. Detailed technical recovery procedures must confirm whether the targets are achievable and identify any capability gaps.

7. Continuity Strategy by Capability

7.1 Customer Operations

Axiom should maintain the ability to receive, prioritize, and communicate customer issues during a service disruption.

Critical customer issues should be triaged first, with approved alternate communication channels available if primary support tooling is unavailable.

7.2 SaaS Platform and Cloud Recovery

Documented recovery procedures should be used to restore critical application services, databases, infrastructure, and supporting services.

Recovery should proceed according to dependency order and include post-recovery health and security validation.

7.3 Identity and Access

Emergency access procedures should be maintained for authorized personnel, with priority given to restoration of identity and privileged-access capabilities.

Emergency access must remain subject to appropriate approval, logging, and subsequent review.

7.4 Security Monitoring and Incident Response

A minimum level of security visibility should be maintained during disruption.

If primary monitoring capabilities become unavailable, approved alternate notification and manual escalation mechanisms should be used until normal visibility is restored.

7.5 Backup and Data Restoration

Recoverable backups should be maintained for critical information and systems.

Recovery should include backup validation, restoration testing, integrity checks, and documentation of recovery results.

7.6 Development and Release Management

Source code and deployment capabilities should be protected while non-critical releases may be deferred during a major disruption.

Security and service-restoration changes may receive priority when required to stabilize operations.

7.7 Vulnerability Management

Risk-based tracking of critical vulnerabilities should continue during a disruption.

Manual tracking may be used temporarily if the normal vulnerability-management workflow is unavailable.

7.8 Third-Party and Supplier Management

Visibility into critical suppliers should be maintained, with supplier-related risks prioritized where they could affect P1 services.

Supplier continuity arrangements should be reviewed for critical cloud, communications, and technology dependencies.

7.9 ISMS Governance and Compliance

Critical governance records should remain accessible and high-priority risk oversight should continue.

Lower-priority governance tasks may be deferred during a major operational disruption.

7.10 Customer and Business Communications

Approved internal and external communication channels and predefined notification processes should be maintained.

Communications should be coordinated with incident response and customer-support activities.

8. Technology Recovery Strategy

Technology recovery should follow a dependency-aware sequence:

1. Establish incident command, communications, and decision authority.
2. Confirm the nature and scope of the disruption and identify affected services.
3. Protect personnel, information, and evidence as applicable.
4. Restore identity and access capabilities required by recovery personnel.

5. Restore foundational cloud, network, database, and supporting services.
6. Restore critical application services and supporting integrations.
7. Restore monitoring and security visibility.
8. Validate data integrity, security controls, application health, and customer-facing functionality.
9. Transition from emergency recovery to normal operations.
10. Document recovery results and lessons learned.

Exact technical recovery procedures, architecture diagrams, backup configurations, failover mechanisms, and provider-specific runbooks belong in the detailed Disaster Recovery Plan and technical recovery procedures rather than this strategy document.

9. People and Organizational Continuity

The continuity strategy should include:

- Primary and backup personnel for P1 activities.
- Current contact information for key recovery roles and critical suppliers.
- Documented and accessible recovery responsibilities.
- Cross-training to reduce dependence on a single individual.
- Appropriate access for authorized recovery personnel while maintaining least privilege.
- Escalation paths to executive decision-makers for events exceeding defined tolerances.

10. Communications Strategy

Audience	Communication Objective	Primary Approach	Fallback
Employees / Response Team	Coordinate response, recovery tasks, and decisions.	Approved collaboration/email channels.	Alternate approved messaging or voice channels.
Customers	Provide timely and accurate service-impact information.	Approved customer communication channels.	Alternate approved customer contact method.
Suppliers	Coordinate restoration, support, and escalation.	Supplier support/escalation channels.	Secondary supplier contact or account representative.
Executive Management	Support risk-based decisions and escalation.	Incident briefings and decision logs.	Voice/manual escalation.
Auditors / Regulators	Provide information where required by applicable obligations.	Controlled formal communication.	Approved alternate communication route.

External notification is event-specific and must be determined using applicable legal, regulatory, contractual, and internal incident-reporting criteria.

11. Supplier and Dependency Resilience

Critical supplier dependencies should be managed through:

- Identification and classification of critical suppliers.
- Security and continuity due diligence proportionate to supplier risk.
- Documented escalation contacts and support arrangements.
- Review of contractual service commitments where relevant.
- Assessment of concentration and single-provider dependencies.
- Contingency or alternate-provider considerations for services whose prolonged loss could exceed the BIA tolerance.

12. Manual Workarounds and Alternate Processing

Manual workarounds should be used only where they are authorized, practical, and secure.

Temporary procedures should prioritize critical customer and operational needs while minimizing data-integrity and security risks.

Capability	Potential Temporary Workaround
Customer Support	Prioritize critical issues through approved alternate communication channels.
Identity & Access	Use documented emergency-access procedures with approval and logging.
Security Monitoring	Use alternate notification, manual escalation, and available log sources.
Development / Release	Defer non-critical releases and prioritize restoration/security changes.
Vulnerability Management	Use risk-based manual tracking for critical findings.
Supplier Management	Prioritize critical suppliers and defer lower-risk reviews.
ISMS Governance	Use controlled offline copies of critical records for high-priority governance activities.
Business Communications	Use predefined alternate communication channels and contact lists.

13. Disaster Recovery and Backup Strategy

The disaster recovery strategy should:

- Identify systems and information requiring backup based on BIA criticality.
- Align backup frequency and retention with approved RPO requirements where technically and economically feasible.
- Protect backups against unauthorized access, accidental deletion, and corruption.
- Maintain sufficient separation between production systems and backup/recovery resources.
- Periodically test restoration rather than relying solely on successful backup jobs.
- Document restoration results, failures, corrective actions, and evidence.
- Review recovery objectives when architecture, data, suppliers, or business requirements materially change.

14. Exercise, Testing, and Validation Strategy

Activity	Purpose	Suggested Frequency	Expected Evidence
Plan Review	Confirm plans remain current and usable.	At least annually and after material change.	Review record / revision history
Tabletop Exercise	Validate decision-making, roles, communications, and recovery assumptions.	At least annually or risk-based.	Scenario pack, attendance, decisions, lessons learned
Technical Recovery Test	Validate restoration of selected critical technology services.	Risk-based / scheduled.	Test record, recovery timing, results
Backup Restoration Test	Confirm backups can be restored and data integrity validated.	Periodic, risk-based.	Restore evidence and test results
Supplier Continuity Review	Validate critical supplier contacts and continuity arrangements.	At least annually.	Supplier review evidence
Post-Incident Review	Identify control, process, and recovery improvements.	After significant disruption or exercise.	Lessons learned and corrective actions

15. Plan Maintenance and Continual Improvement

The BCP/DR framework should be updated when material changes occur, including:

- New or materially changed products, systems, or business processes.
- Changes to critical suppliers or cloud architecture.
- Significant changes to staffing, organizational responsibilities, or operating model.
- Changes to legal, regulatory, contractual, or customer requirements.
- Material changes in risk exposure.
- Findings from incidents, tests, audits, tabletop exercises, or management reviews.

Corrective actions should be tracked to closure with ownership, target dates, priority, and validation evidence.

Significant changes should be reflected in the BIA and associated continuity and recovery plans.

16. Governance and Responsibilities

Role	Strategy Responsibility
Executive Management	Approve strategic recovery priorities, provide escalation authority, and support resource decisions.
Information Security / GRC	Own the BCP/DR governance framework, coordinate BIA reviews, track improvements, and maintain evidence.
Engineering / IT	Own technical recovery capabilities, backup/recovery procedures, and infrastructure restoration.
Customer Operations / Success	Coordinate customer support continuity and customer communications.
Process Owners	Validate business impact, recovery objectives, dependencies, and continuity procedures.
Procurement / GRC	Maintain visibility of critical supplier continuity and security considerations.
All Personnel	Follow approved continuity procedures, escalate disruptions, and participate in exercises as assigned.

17. Implementation Roadmap

Phase	Deliverable	Outcome
1	Business Impact Analysis	Validated critical activities, dependencies, MTPD, RTO, RPO, and priorities.
2	BCP/DR Strategy	Approved strategic recovery and continuity approach.
3	Business Continuity Plan	Business-level continuity procedures, roles, communications, and workarounds.
4	Disaster Recovery Plan	Technical recovery sequences, dependencies, backup/restore, and system recovery procedures.
5	Tabletop Exercise	Validation of roles, decisions, communications, and assumptions.
6	Testing & Lessons Learned	Recovery evidence, gaps, corrective actions, and continual improvement.
7	Review & Maintenance	Ongoing governance and updates based on changes and exercise results.

18. Assumptions and Limitations

The following assumptions apply:

- Axiom AI Technologies is a fictional organization created for portfolio demonstration.
- RTO, RPO, MTPD, staffing, dependency, and recovery assumptions are modeled for demonstration purposes.
- No real customer data, production credentials, live infrastructure, or confidential organizational information is used.
- Detailed technical recovery procedures require architecture-specific information that is intentionally outside this portfolio artifact.
- Real-world continuity arrangements require business-owner validation, resource assessment, contractual review, and management approval.

19. Related Artifacts

The following artifacts support this strategy:

- [Business Impact Analysis \(BIA\)](#)
- [Business Continuity Plan](#)
- [Disaster Recovery Plan](#)
- [Tabletop Exercise Pack](#)
- [Testing & Lessons Learned Record](#)
- [ISMS Objectives](#)
- [ISMS Roles & Responsibilities](#)
- [Statement of Applicability \(SoA\)](#)

20. Portfolio Disclaimer

This document is a fictional cybersecurity/GRC portfolio demonstration.

It is designed to demonstrate practical application of business continuity, disaster recovery, risk management, and ISMS concepts. It does not represent an actual Axiom AI Technologies assessment, certification, audit opinion, or statement of real organizational capabilities.